

whatsUp!

Waterberg happenings news & events December 2016



The Waterberg Trust - Waterberg Challenge - The Result

Riders in the 2016 event still smiling after the arduous four day ride over the mountains and valleys of the Waterberg, maybe thinking of the substantial money they were raising! And it was substantial - more than R170000 for Save the Waterberg Rhino (STWR), more than R112000 for the Lapalala Wilderness School (LWS) and more than R8000 for Lethabo Kids Club.

The STWR money will go to Security - which beefs-up general security in the area, benefiting the whole community: The money to LWS will fund 125 Vaalwater schoolchildren for a three day residential Conservation and Bush skills course with follow-up teaching and the Lethabo donation will provide 50 kids with new shoes, clothes and school bags.

A brilliant initiative - and the next Ride 15 to 21 January is already sold out.

Spotted Hyaena pups born in Welgevonden



Spotted Hyaena are fascinating creatures despite their reputation of being the ugly, badly-behaved menaces of the bush. Their foraging behaviour entails scavenging, which is commonly viewed as a dirty activity, despite it being essential for the functioning of a healthy ecosystem where large predators are present. Despite this reputation spotted hyaena are formidable hunters, especially when they occur in larger clans. They have a very interesting and complex social structure based on a matriarchal society.

Spotted hyaena were never intentionally introduced onto Welgevonden Game Reserve, however their ability to breach game fences has enabled several individuals to establish themselves in the reserve.

A highlight of game viewing on the reserve recently was a very relaxed female with at least one cub at her den.



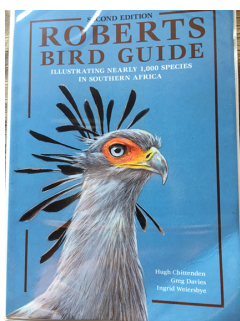
The population size of spotted hyaena on Welgevonden is uncertain, but through analysis of all spotted hyaena images captured during the 2016 PANTHERA Leopard Survey, it has been confirmed that there are at least two resident adult animals. Sadly, the female has abandoned the den, taking the cub with her. This is to be expected as moving the den enables the parasite load to be minimised in both the living quarters and on the animals themselves. A spotted hyaena was seen dragging a wildebeest carcass along Manual Gate Road, they have been heard calling in the west of the reserve and tracks have been seen on the roads which are encouraging signs of their on-going movement.

Phillipa Myram

Photos; Stuart Hill, Lazarus Zulu.

Book review - ROBERTS Bird Guide

Hugh Chittenden, Greg Davies, Ingrid Weiersbye



Not just a new version of the famous guide, this has been completely reworked, with all new vivid artwork frequently backed-up with colour photographs. In many cases the illustrations show differing angles - stationary, in flight etc, and detail, comparing for example, in the case of raptors, close-up head views. With updated distribution maps, detailed species information including calls, eating and nesting habits this is probably the definitive field guide for birders. A minor criticism, the guide shows some alternate (old) names, but not all, like many I still use those.

Robin Taylor

Illegal Signs -

It's good to see the local municipality taking action at last on the proliferation of illegal signs in Vaalwater - and the other local municipalities - see below.

LIM 368 LOCAL MUNICIPALITY



URGENT NOTICE

REMOVAL OF ILLEGAL ADVERTISING BOARDS IN MODIMOLLE, NYLSTROOM TOWN, PHAGAMENG, VAALWATER, LESEDING, ROEDTAN, NABOOMSPRUIT TOWN, MOOKGOPHONG TOWNSHIP

Notice is hereby given by the LIM 368 Local Municipality to the public and business community with regards to the removal of illegal advertising boards within the municipal jurisdiction.

The LIM 368 Local Municipality will remove all illegal boards and advertising signs which are not conforming to the Municipal By-Laws and Advertising Standards.

NB: Businesses and individuals who have put up illegal advertising boards without approval of the Municipality must remove afore said boards as a matter of urgency.

You are therefore given until **31 January 2017**, to remove the boards and failure to make payment the municipality has no option but to remove all boards within our jurisdiction with costs.

The tariffs to advertise are as follows:

DESCRIPTION	CHARGES PER BOARD	BASIC RENTAL COST
Single Gantry: In to Town Out of Town	R9 730.00 R7 441.00	R17 170.00(annual)
Citilite Per Face	R5 152.00	R 10 300.00(annual)
Lightbox Per Ad Per Face	R486.00 R3 888.00	R7 787.00(annual)
Pole Ad Per Site	R 529.00	R529.00(per quarter)
Pave Ad Per Ad	R367.00	R734.00(monthly)
Event Ad Per Ad per event	R8.00 (>50 ads)	R1 550.00(per event, 1-50 ads)

For more information or queries contact Mr M P Shika at 083 287 3363 or office number (014) 718-2045.

Civic Centre
OR Tambo Square
Harry Gwala Street
MODIMOLLE
0510

O P SEBOLA
MUNICIPAL MANAGER

(Notice No: 15/11/2016 – 22/11/2016)

Something to do with a new broom in the Mayoral seat

Speaking of which congratulations to the Mayor's office for communicating so well with the community - check out Marlene Van Staden's Facebook page.

The WNC AGM November 17th 2016

The formal part of the proceedings was concluded quickly with the Chairman's report followed by the Secretary/Treasurer's financial statement and the nomination and election of the Exco which now consists of:

Robin Taylor Chair
Jessica Babich Deputy Chair
Susan Walker Secretary/Treasurer
Sue Jarman
Kelly Abram
Brad Algar
Letticia Mahlatji
Peggy Parham
Phinius Sebatsane
Greg Canning
Solly Nkhumane

Moving on to the meeting we had two really outstanding and interesting guest speakers - **Jonathan Swart**, Research Ecologist at Welgevonden and one of the world's foremost authorities on pangolins who gave a fascinating, in-depth insight into this critically endangered and little known species.



Professor John Donaldson Chief Director, Applied Biodiversity Research at SANBI, gave a presentation emphasising the difficulties faced by conservationists in balancing wildlife trade, conservation and sustainable development - indeed 'walking a tightrope' - a thought-provoking and absorbing talk.



The speakers were followed by the much anticipated wine-tasting of **Painted Wolf Wines** presented by owner **Jeremy Borg**. Prior to the tasting, Jeremy gave us background on the wines and the way the company works with EWT to support efforts to save the endangered and iconic Wild Dog.

WNC member **Corne du Plessis** auctioned a number of items donated by WNC members - thanks to WNC members **Craig Pidduck of Bullseye Taxidermy, Clive Walker, Tracy Cleet and Alan, Bertus van Zyl of Bee Living, Ken Maud, Heidi Carlton of Waterberg Heatwave, Erika Albertyn of GEA Foods, Nadine Goddard of Adorn and Robin Taylor** for their generous donations. The auction raised R6550.

Members and guests then went on to enjoy the braai and drinks while networking and discussing matters of mutual interest.

Robin Taylor - Images: Alan Jarman

The WNC continues to attract new members - welcome to;

Linda Fouche

David Heppell

Angela Ricci of Morongwane

New Corporate member PDI

Some Commercial News



Established in 2014 Bushbaby Maintenance and Management is owner-run by Steven Leonard. The company offers comprehensive services to lodges ranging from property management and general maintenance to relief guiding and lodge management.

Contact Steven on 0724433561 -

steven@bushbabymaintenance.co.za

Please Diarise the first three Meetings for 2017

February 16 -- May 11 -- June 29

We would like to wish everyone a Merry Christmas and a Happy and Prosperous New Year

The Waterberg Nature Conservancy

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